

REMEMBER

1. Believe in yourself, you can easily score 100%
2. Before solving any question, first clear your concepts related to that question.
3. Always try to solve yourself first then check doc solution (while attempting questions 1st time).
4. Practice a lot and try to solve all questions in 2 hrs.

Read the instruction carefully.

1. There will be one controller machine and 5 nodes.
 2. You will be provided the root login and root password, and you have to create playbooks via admin user. [Login on controller node with root then switch to admin user]
 3. Create all your playbooks in /home/admin/ansible [mkdir /home/admin/ansible]
 4. Create config and inventory file in /home/admin/ansible/
 5. Create a roles directory in /home/admin/ansible/ [mkdir /home/admin/ansible/roles]
-

Note: vim command will not be working, so you have to install vim in your controller machine (yum install vim -y) but vi command will be accessible.

First step -> read instructions carefully

Second step -> ssh <given user>@< master/controller node name >

Third key step - > yum install vim -y

(Optional Part just to configure vim in controller node)

In admin home directory to create the .vimrc file

```
vim /home/admin/.vimrc
```

```
set ai
```

```
set ts=2
```

```
set et
```

```
set cursorcolumn
```

Step1: Read the instructions carefully, there you'll get ip addresses and fqdn of all nodes & root password of controller node. And folder name where you have to put all playbooks and config file. Also username of managed node and some other things.

Remember: - We won't need root password anywhere.

- User name of managed node and controller node would be same.

Step2: ssh to controller node on root account. Then switch user(su - username).

Step3: Install and setup vim, install ansible

Step4: Create folder with that name given in instruction

Step5: Start solving questions

Q1)

Install and configure Ansible

Install and configure Ansible on control node control.sector1.example.com as

follows:Install the required packages

Create a static inventory file called /home/Catherine/ansible/inventory so that:

node1 is a member of the **dev** host group

node2 is a member of the **test** host group

node3 and **node4** are member of the **prod** host group

node5 is a member of the **balancers** host group

The **prod** group is a member of the **webserver** host group

Create a configuration file called /home/Catherine/ansible/ansible.cfg so that:

The host inventory file is /home/Catherine/ansible/inventory

The default content collections directory is /home/Catherine/ansible/mycollection

The default roles directory is /home/Catherine/ansible/roles

INSTRUCTION:

For this ques, you'll find hostname in instructions.

After solving, always check:

- Ansible all -m ping (check connectivity)
- Ansible all -a 'id' (check if privilege escalation working or not, its running command with root power or not)

If you are not getting root, then there's issue in ansible.cfg file.

Solution:

```
yum install ansible-core -y  
yum install ansible-navigator -y
```

```
mkdir /home/Catherine/ansible/mycollection  
mkdir /home/Catherine/ansible/roles  
mkdir /home/Catherine/ansible
```

```
vim /home/Catherine/ansible/inventory
```

```
[dev] node1
```

```
[test] node2
```

```
[prod]
```

```
node[3:4] # range method to define the multiple fqdns in single string range
```

```
[balancers] node5
```

```
[webserver:children] #super group logic given in book prod
```

```
vim /home/Catherine/ansible/ansible.cfg
```

```
[defaults]
```

```
inventory = inventory  
roles_path = /home/Catherine/ansible/roles  
collections_path = /home/Catherine/ansible/mycollection  
remote_user = tom  
ask_pass = false  
host_key_checking = false
```

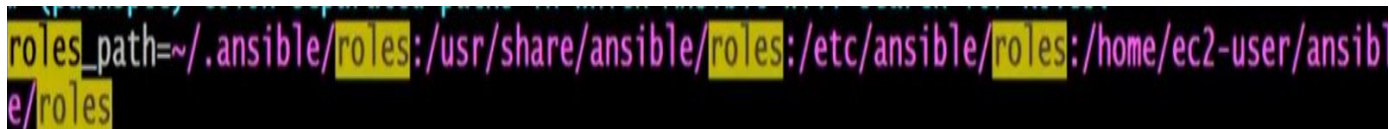
```
[privilege_escalation]
```

```
become = true  
become_method = sudo  
become_user = root  
become_ask_pass = false
```

NOTE - To get everything automatically in ansible.cfg use -
ansible-config init --disabled > ansible.cfg



```
collections_path=~/ansible/collections:/usr/share/ansible/collections:/home/ec2-user/ansible  
/mycollection
```



```
roles_path=~/ansible/roles:/usr/share/ansible/roles:/etc/ansible/roles:/home/ec2-user/ansib  
le/roles
```

Q2. Create and run an Ansible ad-hoc command. As a system administrator, you will need to install software on the managed nodes.

Create a shell script called yum-pack.sh that runs an Ansible ad-hoc command to create a yum repository on each of the managed nodes as follows:

NOTE: you need to create 2 repos (BaseOS and AppStream) in managed node side

i) BaseOS

a. name: baseos

b. baseurl: http://classroom.example.com/content/rhel8.0/x86_64/dvd/BaseOS/

c. description:Base OS Repo

d. gpgcheck: yes

e. enabled: yes

key: http://classroom.example.com/content/rhel8.0/x86_64/dvd/RPM-GPG-KEY-redhat-release

ii) AppStream

a. name: appstream

b. baseurl: http://classroom.example.com/content/rhel8.0/x86_64/dvd/AppStream/

c. description:Appstrean Repo

d. gpgcheck: yes

e. enabled: yes

key: http://classroom.example.com/content/rhel8.0/x86_64/dvd/RPM-GPG-KEY-redhat-release

INSTRUCTIONS:

Solve this question carefully as its base for most of the upcoming questions.

Always check after solving as sometimes we do small mistakes and yum not configure properly and we won't even know. Then we'll get errors in installing packages while running playbooks.

Q. Simplest way to check?

Ans: → `ansible all -a 'yum repolist'` (use ansible adhoc command to check)
If you're getting packages in BaseOs and Appstream both, then it's fine.

Q. What's "-b" at the end of each command?

Ans. It's for running that command with root power. (We can also remove that as we have already given privilege escalation in inventory file)

Q. What is gpg key?

Ans. It's for verifying the software.

Link: <https://www.redhat.com/sysadmin/rpm-gpg-verify-packages>

Solution:

```
vim yum-pack.sh
```

```
#!/bin/bash
```

```
ansible all -m yum_repository -a 'file=external_repo name=baseos description="Base OS
Repo" baseurl=http://classroom.example.com/content/rhel8.0/x86_64/dvd/BaseOS/
gpgcheck=yes gpgkey=http://classroom.example.com/content/rhel8.0/x86_64/dvd/RPM-
GPG-KEY-redhat-release enabled=yes state=present' -b
```

```
ansible all -m yum_repository -a 'file=external_repo name=appstream description="AppStream
Repo" baseurl=http://classroom.example.com/content/rhel8.0/x86_64/dvd/AppStream/
gpgcheck=yes gpgkey=http://classroom.example.com/content/rhel8.0/x86_64/dvd/RPM-
GPG-KEY-redhat-release enabled=yes state=present' -b
```

```
chmod +x yum-pack.sh
./yum-pack
```

Q3. Create a playbook called /home/Catherine/ansible/packages.yml that:

- Installs the php and mariadb packages on hosts in the dev, test, and prod host groups
- Installs the RPM Development Tools package group on hosts in the dev host group
- Updates all packages to the latest version on hosts in the dev host group

INSTRUCTIONS:

Before solving this, let's clear the concept of package groups first.

On rhel, we can either install software (RPM) individually or install related software in group.

Package group contain packages that perform related tasks such as development tools, web servers.

Some command, just to get familiar with package group:

- Yum groups summary
- yum groups list
- yum groups info "RPM Development Tools"
- yum groups install "RPM Development Tools"
- yum groups remove "RPM Development Tools"

Solution:

```
> vim /home/Catherine/ansible/packages.yml
```

```
---
```

```
- name: Playbook for packages.yml
```

```
  hosts: all
```

```
  vars:
```

```
    pkgs:
```

```
      - php
```

```
      - mariadb
```

```
  tasks:
```

```
    - name: install the packages
```

```
      yum:
```

```
    name: "{{ item }}"
    state: present
    loop: "{{ pkgs }}"
    when: inventory_hostname in groups['dev'] or inventory_hostname in groups['test'] or
inventory_hostname in groups['prod']
```

- name: install the RPM development tool package group

yum:

name: "@RPM Development tools"

state: present

when: inventory_hostname in groups['dev']

- name: update all packages

yum:

name: '*'

state: latest

when: inventory_hostname in groups['dev']

Q4. Install the RHEL system roles package and create a playbook called /home/Catherine/ansible/timesync.yml that:

-- Runs on all managed hosts

-- Uses the timesync role

-- Configures the role to use the time server 172.25.254.250

-- Configure the role to set the iburst parameter as enabled

INSTRUCTIONS:

For this ques, you can easily get examples in README.md file, you can copy paste from here:

- cat /usr/share/ansible/roles/rhel-system-roles.timesync/README.md

And don't forget to give full path of role in playbook otherwise it won't work.

For practice in local lab, you have to add one more repo in yum repository for centos repo for installing updated version of system roles:

http://mirror.centos.org/centos/8/AppStream/x86_64/os/

Ques: What are system roles?

Ans: System roles are pre created roles certified by RedHat present in system.

<https://www.redhat.com/sysadmin/ansible-system-role>

Ques: What is timesync role?

Ans: timesync role installs and configures NTP to be operated as NTP client to synchronize the system clock with NTP server.

Solution:

```
sudo yum install rhel-system-roles
```

```
vim /home/Catherine/ansible/timesync.yml
```

```
---
```

```
- name: playbook for timesync.yml
```

```
  hosts: all
```

```
  vars:
```

```
    timesync_ntp_servers:
```

```
      - hostname: 172.25.254.250
```

```
      iburst: yes
```

```
  roles:
```

```
    - /usr/share/ansible/roles/rhel-system-roles.timesync
```

```
...
```

Q5. Create a role called apache in /home/Catherine/ansible/roles with the following requirements

- The httpd package is installed, enabled on boot, and started

- The firewall is enabled and running with a rule to allow access to the web server

- A template file index.html.j2 exists (you have to create this file) and is used to create the file /var/www/html/index.html with the following output:

```
Welcome to HOSTNAME on IPADDRESS
```

- where HOSTNAME is the fully qualified domain name of the managed node and IPADDRESS is the IP address of the managed node.

- Create a playbook called /home/Catherine/ansible/newrole.yml that uses this role as follows:

- * The playbook runs on hosts in the webservers host group

Ques: Do we have to use default_ipv4.address or enp0s3.ipv4.address in exam?

Ans: Use default one.

Ques: In doc, there's two way given to solve this. Which one should I use?

Ans: Try to use 2nd one (which has vars file), because purpose of role is to separate components instead of putting them in one single file. So, try to use separate vars file of role.

Solution:

```
> ansible-galaxy init --init-path=roles apache
```



```
> vim roles/apache/tasks/main.yml
```

```
- name: install all packages
```

```
  yum:
```

```
    name: "{{ item }}"
```

```
    state: present
```

```
    loop: "{{ pkgs }}"
```

```
- name: start and enable the services
```

```
  service:
```

```
    name: "{{ item }}"
```

```
    state: started
```

```
    enabled: true
```

```
    loop: "{{ pkgs }}"
```

```
- name:
```

```
  firewallld:
```

```
    service: "{{ item }}"
```

```
    permanent: true
```

```
    immediate: true
```

```
    state: enabled
```

```
    loop: "{{ rule }}"
```

```
- name: create info file from template
```

```
  template:
```

```
    src: index.html.j2
```

```
    dest: /var/www/html/index.html
```

```
> vim roles/apache/vars/main.yml # for vars for above role task
```

```
pkgs:
```

```
- httpd
```

```
- firewallld
```

```
rule:
```

```
- http
```

```
- https
```

```
> vim roles/apache/templates/index.html.j2
```

```
Welcome to {{ ansible_facts['fqdn'] }} on {{ ansible_facts['default_ipv4']['address'] }}
```

```
> vim apacherole.yml
```

```
---  
- name: playbook for apache role  
  hosts: prod  
  roles:  
    - role: apache  
...
```

Q6. Use Ansible Galaxy with a requirements file called
/home/Catherine/ansible/roles/requirement.yml to download and install roles to
/home/admin/ansible/roles from the following URLs:

```
-- http://classroom.example.com/content/examfun.tar.gz
```

The name of this role should be balancer

```
-- http://classroom.example.com/content/examfun.tar.gz
```

The name of this role should be phpinfo

Ques: What's that requirement file?

Ans: If have lots of URL to download and install roles, we can put all the URLs in one file and give the name of role. Hence install all the roles at once.

They install roles by default at the role path given in Inventory.

Solution:

```
vim /home/Catherine/ansible/roles/requirements.yml
```

```
---  
- src: http://classroom.example.com/content/examfun.tar.gz  
  name: balancer
```

```
- src: http://classroom.example.com/content/examfun.tar.gz  
  name: phpinfo
```

```
...
```

```
ansible-galaxy install -r roles/requirement.yml -p roles/
```

pwd before running the command must be /home/Catherine/ansible

Q7. Create a playbook called balance.yml as follows:

The playbook contains a play that runs on hosts in the balancers host group and uses the balancer role.

- This role configures a service to load balance web server requests between hosts in the webservers host group.

- When implemented, browsing to hosts in the balancers host group (for example `http://node5.example.com`) should produce the following output:

Welcome to node3.example.com on 192.168.10.2

- Reloading the browser should return output from the alternate web server:

Welcome to node4.example.com on 192.168.10.2

* The playbook contains a play that runs on hosts in the webservers host group and uses the phphello role.

When implemented, browsing to hosts in the webservers host group with the URL `/hello.php` should produce the following output:

Hello PHP World from FQDN

where FQDN is the fully qualified domain name of the host.

For example, browsing to `http://node3.example.com/hello.php`, should produce the following output:

Hello PHP World from node3.example.com

along with various details of the PHP configuration including the version of PHP that is installed.

* Similarly, browsing to `http://node4.example.com/hello.php`, should produce the following output:

Hello PHP World from node4.example.com

along with various details of the PHP configuration including the version of PHP that is installed.

INSTRUCTIONS:

This one is the easiest question. Here you just have to use the roles installed in previous question.

Ques: why we are first running a play on all nodes without any task?

Ans: To gather information of other nodes that is used by balancer role.

Solution:

```
vim balance.yml
```

```
---
```

```
- hosts: all
```

```
  task: []
```

- name: play for balancer group
 - hosts: balancers
 - roles:
 - balancer
- name: play for webserver group
 - hosts: webserver
 - roles:
 - phpinfo
- ...

Q8. Create a playbook called web.yml as follows:

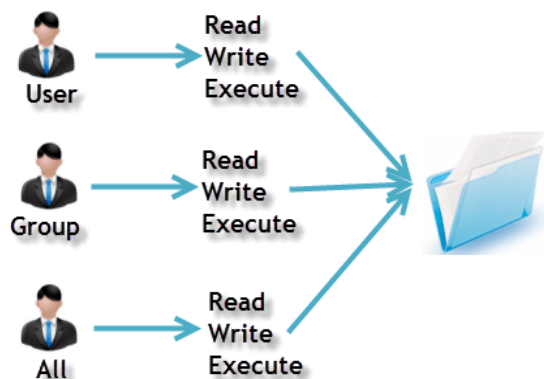
- * The playbook runs on managed nodes in the dev host group
- * Create the directory /webdev with the following requirements:
 - membership in the webdev group
 - * regular permissions: owner=read+write+execute, group=read+write+execute, other=read+execute
 - special permissions: set group ID
- * Symbolically link /var/www/html/webdev to /webdev
- * Create the file /webdev/index.html with a single line of text that reads: Development

INSTRUCTIONS:

For this question, first clear you concept about permissions and SELinux.

Octal	Decimal	Permission	Representation
000	0 (0+0+0)	No Permission	---
001	1 (0+0+1)	Execute	--x
010	2 (0+2+0)	Write	-w-
011	3 (0+2+1)	Write + Execute	-wx
100	4 (4+0+0)	Read	r--
101	5 (4+0+1)	Read + Execute	r-x
110	6 (4+2+0)	Read + Write	rw-
111	7 (4+2+1)	Read + Write + Execute	rwx

Owners assigned Permission On Every File and Directory



In this ques, 1st we have to create directory with given permission then asked to create shortcut of folder called symbolic link. So we have to create one more source for this destination.

Then it's asked to create a file index.html in /webdev folder that is linked to /var/www/html.

But we can't disable SELinux in exam. Here we're creating index.html in other folder (/webdev) linked to document root (/var/www/html). SELinux won't allow this (because /var/www/html don't have access to file of some other folder because of SELinux).

That's why we are setting permission – setype: "httpd_sys_content_t"

Due to this permission, apache webserver is using this folder. So same permission we are giving to /webdev/index.html

Don't forget to give ownership of apache user.

After solving this ques always check using curl.

> Curl node1.example.com/webdev/ (It should print Development)

Q. What is httpd_sys_content_t?

Ans: httpd_sys_content_t -> this is the permission of apache webserver.

Q. What if I forget this permission in exam?

Ans: Go to the node where httpd is installed. Check permission of document root.

-> ls -Z -d /var/www/html

Ques: Why given 02775?

Ans: 0 -> we are adding leading 0 so that ansible know it's it's an octal number. You will get more information about this in "ansible-doc file". In argument – "mode".

2 -> set GID permission

7 -> Owner(read + write + execute)

7 -> Group(read + write + execute)

5 - > Others(read + execute)

Ques: What is GID?

Ans: Groups in Linux are defined by GID (group id).

When set group ID permission is applied to a directory, files that were created in this directory belong to the group to which the directory belongs. Any user who has write or execute permission in the directory can create a file here. However the files belongs to the groups that owns the directory, not to the user's group ownership.

Hence Files in that directory will have the same group as the group of parent directory.

Solution:

vim web.yml

- hosts: prod

tasks:

- group:

name: webdev

- file:

state: directory

path: /webdev

mode: 02775

group: webdev

owner: apache

setype: "httpd_sys_content_t"

- file:

src: /webdev

path: /var/www/html/myweb

state: link

mode: 02775

owner: apache

setype: "httpd_sys_content_t"

- copy:

dest: /webdev/index.html

mode: 0640

content: "Depolyment"

owner: apache

setype: "httpd_sys_content_t"

...

Q9. Create an Ansible vault to store user passwords as follows:

- * The name of the vault is vault.yml

- * The vault contains two variables as follows:

 - dev_pass with value wakenym

 - mgr_pass with value rocky

- * The password to encrypt and decrypt the vault is atenorth

- * The password is stored in the file /home/admin/ansible/password.txt

Note: Don't forget to change permission of password.txt (where we store password)

Solution:

```
vim password.txt
```

```
atenorth
```

```
ansible-vault create --vault-password-file=password.txt vault.yml
```

```
dev_pass: wakenym
```

```
mgr_pass: rocky
```

```
chmod 0600 password.txt
```

Q10. Generate a hosts file:

- * Download an initial template file called hosts.j2 from

<http://classroom.example.com/content/hosts.j2> to /home/admin/ansible/. Complete the template so that it can be used to generate a file with a line for each inventory host in the same format as /etc/hosts

- * Create a playbook called gen_hosts.yml that uses this template to generate the file /etc/myhosts on hosts in the dev host group.

- * When completed, the file /etc/myhosts on hosts in the dev host group should have a line for each managed host:

```
127.0.0.1 localhost localhost.localdomain localhost4 localhost4.localdomain4
::1      localhost localhost.localdomain localhost6 localhost6.localdomain6
```

```
192.168.10.x node1.example.com node1
```

```
192.168.10.y node2.example.com node2
```

```
192.168.10.z node3.example.com node3
```

```
192.168.10.a node4.example.com node4
```

```
192.168.10.b node5.example.com node5
```

INSTRUCTIONS:

For this question, 1st clear the concept of hostvars and groups.

Hostvars, groups, inventory_hostname are some magic variables in ansible.

- `group_names`: List of groups the current host is part of
- `groups`: A dictionary/map with all the groups in inventory and list of hosts belonging to each group.
- `hostvars`: A dictionary/map with all the hosts in inventory and variables assign to them. With `hostvars` you can access variables defined for any host in play. `ansible_facts` is also one of the variable of `hostvars`, from there we can retrieve everything about that host. Try to explore yourself what all it contains to get comfortable with it.

As this file should have IP, fqdn and hostname of all nodes, therefore first we are running a play on all nodes to gather these information.

Solution:

```
wget http://classroom.example.com/content/hosts.j2
```

```
vim hosts.j2
```

```
127.0.0.1 localhost localhost.localdomain localhost4 localhost4.localdomain4
::1      localhost localhost.localdomain localhost6 localhost6.localdomain6
```

```
{% for x in groups['all'] %}
{{ hostvars[x]['ansible_facts']['default_ipv4']['address'] }} {{
hostvars[x]['ansible_facts']['fqdn'] }} {{ hostvars[x]['ansible_facts']['hostname'] }}
{% endfor %}
```

```
vim gen_hosts.yml
```

```
- hosts: all
  tasks: []

- hosts: dev
  tasks:
    - template:
        src: "/home/user/ansible/hostdetails.j2"
        dest: "/etc/myhosts"
```

Q11. Create a playbook called `hwreport.yml` that produces an output file called `/root/hwreport.txt` on all managed nodes with the following information:

```
-- Inventory host name
```

```
-- Total memory in MB
```

```
-- BIOS version
```

```
-- Size of disk device vda
```



```
-- Size of disk device vdb
Each line of the output file contains a single keyvalue pair.
* Your playbook should:
-- Download the file hwreport.empty from the URL
http://classroom.example.com/content/hwreport.empty and save it as /root/hwreport.txt
-- Modify with the correct values.
NOTE: If a hardware item does not exist, the associated value should be set to NULL.
```

For solving this ques, many of us came across two ways and get confused.

Both are correct and you'll get full marks in both.

1st one is easiest and takes less time.

2nd one is little bit lengthy but its exact solution of this ques.

I suggest practice both and use that one in which you are comfortable.

I practiced both but in exam I used 1st approach because of time.

In exam, you'll get hwreport.empty file like this:

```
-- Inventory host name: hostname
-- Total memory in MB: memory
-- BIOS version: bios_version
-- Size of disk device vda: vda_size
-- Size of disk device vdb: vdb_size
```

1st sol:

Step1: Download file on controller node

Step2: Copy it in /home/admin/ansible/hwreport.j2

Step3: Create hwreport.yml till rescue – debug (don't add 2nd template task)

Step4: Run the playbook and check errors that we have registered in hwreport variable

Step5: Create copy of hwreport.j2 -> hwreport2.j2

Step6: Modify hwreport2.j2 according to error you're getting.

Step7: Add remaining template task in playbook and run.

Solution:

(Note: remove vdb from serverd - for making the scenerio)

```
wget http://classroom.example.com/content/hwreport.empty
```

```
vim hwreport.j2
```

```
-- Inventory host name : {{ ansible_facts['fqdn'] }}
-- Total memory in MB: {{ ansible_facts['memtotal_mb'] }}
-- BIOS version: {{ ansible_facts['bios_version'] }}
-- Size of disk device vda: {{ ansible_facts['devices']['vda']['size'] }}
-- Size of disk device vdb: {{ ansible_facts['devices']['vdb']['size'] }}
```

vim hwreport2.j2

```
-- Inventory host name : {{ ansible_facts['fqdn'] }}
-- Total memory in MB: {{ ansible_facts['memtotal_mb'] }}
-- BIOS version: {{ ansible_facts['bios_version'] }}
-- Size of disk device vda: {{ ansible_facts['devices']['vda']['size'] }}
{% if 'AnsibleUndefinedVariable' in hwreport.msg %}
-- Size of disk device vdb: NULL
{% endif %}
```

vim hwreport.yml

```
---
- name: playbook for hwreport.yml
  hosts: all
  tasks:
    - block:
      - name: generate hardware report
        template:
          src: hwreport.j2
          dest: /root/hwreport.txt
          register: hwreport

    rescue:
      - debug:
          var: hwreport

    - name: generate hardware report on missing
      template:
        src: hwreport2.j2
        dest: /root/hwreport.txt
```

...

Or

2nd approach:

Step1: Write the playbook to download file in all nodes and run.

Step2: ssh to any node and cat /root/hwreport.txt, copy the content and exit.

Step3: Paste the content at bottom of the playbook.

Step4: Then write further tasks for replacing content using the content we pasted in previous step.

- name: playbook running on all the nodes
hosts: all

vars:

- destination: "/root/hwreport.txt"

tasks:

- name: downloading url

get_url:

url: "http://classroom.example.com/content/hwreport.empty "

dest: "{{ destination }}"

- name: replacing hostname content

replace:

regexp: "hostname"

path: "{{ destination }}"

replace: "{{ ansible_hostname }}"

- name: replacing memory content

replace:

regexp: "memory"

path: "{{ destination }}"

replace: "{{ ansible_memtotal_mb }}"

- name: replacing bios version content

replace:

regexp: "bios_version"

path: "{{ destination }}"

replace: "{{ ansible_bios_version }}"

- name: replacing sda size content

replace:

regexp: "sda_size"

path: "{{ destination }}"

replace: "{{ ansible_facts['devices']['sda']['size'] }}"

register: sda_info

ignore_errors: yes

- name: replacing sda size with NONE

replace:

regexp: "sda_size"

path: "{{ destination }}"

replace: "NONE"

```

when: sdb_info.failed == true

- name: replacing sdb size content
  replace:
    regexp: "sdb_size"
    path: "{{ destination }}"
    replace: "{{ ansible_facts['devices']['sdb']['size'] }}"
    register: sdb_info
    ignore_errors: yes

- name: replacing sdb size with NONE
  replace:
    regexp: "sdb_size"
    path: "{{ destination }}"
    replace: "NONE"
    when: sdb_info.failed == true
...

```

Q12. Modify file content in all hosts. Create a playbook called /home/Catherine/ansible/issue.yml as follows:

- * The playbook runs on all inventory hosts
- * The playbook replaces the contents of /etc/issue with a single line of text as follows:
 - On hosts in the dev host group, the line reads: Development
 - On hosts in the test host group, the line reads: Test
 - On hosts in the prod host group, the line reads: Production

Solution:

vim issue.yml

```

---
- name: playbook for issue.yml
  hosts: all
  tasks:
    - name: replace the content in dev group
      copy:
        content: "Development"
        dest: /etc/issue
        when: inventory_hostname in groups['dev']

    - name: replace the content in test group
      copy:
        content: "Test"

```

```
dest: /etc/issue
when: inventory_hostname in groups['test']
```

```
- name: replace the content in prod group
  copy:
    content: "Production"
    dest: /etc/issue
    when: inventory_hostname in groups['prod']
```

...

Q13. Rekey an existing Ansible vault as follows:

- * Download the Ansible vault from `"http://classroom.example.com/content/secret.yml"`
- * The current vault password is `curabete`
- * The new vault password is `newvare`
- * The vault remains in an encrypted state with the new password

Solution:

```
wget http://classroom.example.com/content/secret.yml
```

```
ansible-vault rekey --ask-vault-pass secret.yml
```

Vault password: `curabete`

New Vault password: `newvare`

Confirm New Vault password: `newvare`

Rekey successful

Note: After solving this ques in exam, always check the new password that you set. Because sometimes we do mistake in copy-pasting as it's not visible what we are pasting there.

Q14. Create user accounts. A list of users to be created can be found in the file called

`user_list.yml` which you should download from

`"http://classroom.example.com/content/user_list.yml"` and save to `/home/admin/ansible/`.

* Using the password vault created elsewhere in this exam, create a playbook called `create_user.yml` that creates user accounts as follows:

* Users with a job description of `developer` should be:

- created on managed nodes in the `dev` and `test` host groups assigned the password from the `dev_pass` variable and is a member of supplementary group `devops`

* Users with a job description of `manager` should be:

- created on managed nodes in the `prod` host group assigned the password from the `mgr_pass` variable and is a member of supplementary group `opsmgr`

* Passwords should use the SHA512 hash format. Your playbook should work using the vault password file created elsewhere in this exam.

INSTRUCTIONS:

In this question, we just have to create users as per following:

- use the user_list file as vars file to get username
- use vault.yml created in ques 9 as password file.(we can also use vault file as var file)
- write two tasks for creating user. One with condition job description = developer and another with condition job description = manager. (job description is given in user_list file)

Note: while running playbook, don't forget to provide vault password file (--vault-password-file=password.txt)

Solution:

```
wget http://classroom.example.com/content/user_list.yml
```

```
cat user_list.yml
```

```
users:
```

- name: adam
 job: developer
- name: gabriel
 job: manager
- name: lucifer
 job: developer

```
vim create_user.yml
```

```
---
```

```
- name: playbook for create_user.yml
```

```
  hosts: all
```

```
  vars_files:
```

- user_list.yml
- vault.yml

```
  tasks:
```

```
    - name: create the groups
```

```
      group:
```

```
        name: "{{ item }}"
```

```
      state: present
```

```
      loop:
```

- devops
- opsmgr

```
    - name: create the users with developer job profile
```

```
      user:
```

```

name: "{{ item.name }}"
groups: devops
append: true
password: "{{ dev_pass | password_hash('sha512') }}"
state: present
loop: "{{ users }}"
when:
  - item.job == 'developer'
  - inventory_hostname in groups['dev'] or inventory_hostname in groups['test']

```

- name: create the users with manager job profile

```

user:
  name: "{{ item.name }}"
  groups: opsmgr
  append: true
  password: "{{ mgr_pass | password_hash('sha512') }}"
  state: present
loop: "{{ users }}"
when:
  - item.job == 'manager'
  - inventory_hostname in groups['prod']

```

...

ansible-playbook create_user.yml --vault-password-file=password.txt

Q15. Create a playbook storage.yml for creating Logical volumes in all nodes according to following requirements.

- * Create a new Logical volume named as 'data'
- * LV should be the member of 'research' Volume Group
- * LV size should be 1500M
- * It should be formatted with ext4 filesystem.

```

-- If Volume Group does not exist then it should print the message "VG Not found"
-- If the VG can not accomodate 1500M size then it should print "LV Can not be
created with following size"
-- then the LV should be created with 800M of size.
-- Do not perform any mounting for this LV.

```

INSTRUCTION:

First clear the LVM concept before practicing this question.

In exam, vdb will be there in 4 nodes. Partitions and vg (volume group) will be already created. You just have to create lv (logical volume).

Out of these 4 nodes, one node will have vg with space less than 1500. (Probably node4)
So according to condition given in ques, here you have to create lv of size 800M and also print the message.

In one node (probably node5), vg will not be there. So for this node, in rescue part you have to print a message (debug) "VG Not Found".

In our lab, for creating exam environment (partitions and vg), first attach a hard disk of size > 1500M. Then create partitions and vg. For creating these you can run the playbook "lvm.yml".

In solution, we are using block and rescue and when for managing errors and conditions.

Step1: Write playbook till rescue – debug: lv_info (from this we can print errors that we will further use in when condition.)

Step2: Using those errors, write further playbook for debug and creating lvm with size 800m

Step4: Then in always write task for creating filesystem/format

[Only to do here for creating the scenario]

```
vim lvm.yml
```

```
---
```

```
- name: playbook for lvm creation
```

```
  hosts: all
```

```
  tasks:
```

```
    - name: create new partion
```

```
      parted:
```

```
        device: /dev/vdb
```

```
        number: 1
```

```
        state: present
```

```
        part_end: 2GB
```

```
      when: ansible_hostname == 'servera' or ansible_hostname == 'serverb' or  
            ansible_hostname == 'serverc'
```

```
    - name: create a volume group
```

```
      lvg:
```

```
        vg: research
```

```
        pvs: /dev/vdb1
```

```
      when: ansible_hostname == 'servera' or ansible_hostname == 'serverb' or  
            ansible_hostname == 'serverc'
```

```
    - name: create new partion
```

```
      parted:
```



```
device: /dev/vdb
number: 1
state: present
part_end: 1GB
when: ansible_hostname == 'serverd'
```

```
- name: create a volume group
  lvg:
    vg: research
    pvs: /dev/vdb1
  when: ansible_hostname == 'serverd'
```

...

Solution:

vim storage.yml

```
- name: playbook for storage.yml
  hosts: all
  tasks:
    - block:
        - name: Create a logical volume of 1500M
          lvol:
            vg: research
            lv: data
            size: 1500m
            register: lv_info

        rescue:
          - debug:
              var: lv_info

          - debug:
              msg: " VG Not found"
              when: "'does not exist' in lv_info.msg"

          - debug:
              msg: "LV Can not be created with following size"
              when: "'insufficient free space' in lv_info.err"

        - name: Create a logical volume of 800M
          lvol:
```

```
vg: research
lv: data
size: 800m
register: lv_info_new
when: "'insufficient free space' in lv_info.err'
```

```
- debug:
var: lv_info_new
```

```
always:
- name: create filesystem
filesystem:
fstype: ext4
dev: "/dev/research/data"
```

...

Check: -
ansible all -a 'lvmdisplay'
ansible all -a 'blkid'

Q16) Configure a cron job

Create a playbook called /home/Catherine/ansible/cron.yml that runs on all managed hosts and creates a cron job for user Natasha as follows:

The user Natasha must configure a cron job that runs every 2 minutes and executes logger

"EX294 in progress"

Solution –

```
# cd /home/Catherine/ansible
# vim cron.yml
```

```
ec2-user@ip-172-31-11-40:~/ansible
- hosts: all
  become: true
  tasks:
  - ansible.builtin.cron:
      name: myname
      minute: "*/2"
      job: 'logger "EX294 in progress"'
      user: natasha
```

```
# ansible-navigator run -m stdout cron.yml --syntax-check cron.yml
# ansible-navigator run -m stdout cron.yml
```

Q17)

Install a Collection

Install the following collection artifacts available from <http://rhgl.ssector1.example.com/materials> to control.ssector1.example.com as the user Catherine

redhat-rhel_system_roles-

1.16.2.tar.gzansible-posix-

1.4.0.tar.gz

community-general-4.3.0.tar.gz

The collections should be installed into the default collections directory `/home/Catherine/ansible/mycollections`

```
# yum install wget -y
# cd /home/Catherine/ansible/mycollection
# podman login <registry name>
# wget <url path>
# podman pull <image path>
# dnf install rhel-system-roles.noarch
```

Q18) Using a selinux role create a selinux.yml playbook to configure on all managed hosts to set the default target as permissive

Solution:

```
# pwd
# ansible-galaxy install linux-system-roles.selinux
# vim playbook.yml
- name: creating a play for selinux
  hosts: all
  vars:
    selinux_status:
  roles:
    - linux-system-roles.selinux
```

```
# ansible-navigator run -m stdout playbook.yml --syntax-check
# ansible-navigator run -m stdout playbook.yml
```

TIPS FOR EXAM

- **IF you forget any module name**

You can search for module name using ansible-doc command.

→ `ansible-doc -l | grep <keyword_related_to_module>`

EX: `ansible-doc -l | grep yum`

By this approach you can find the module name.

- **If you forget any arguments of module**

You can see the documentation of any module using ansible-doc command.

→ `ansible-doc <module_name>`

EX: `ansible-doc yum_repository`

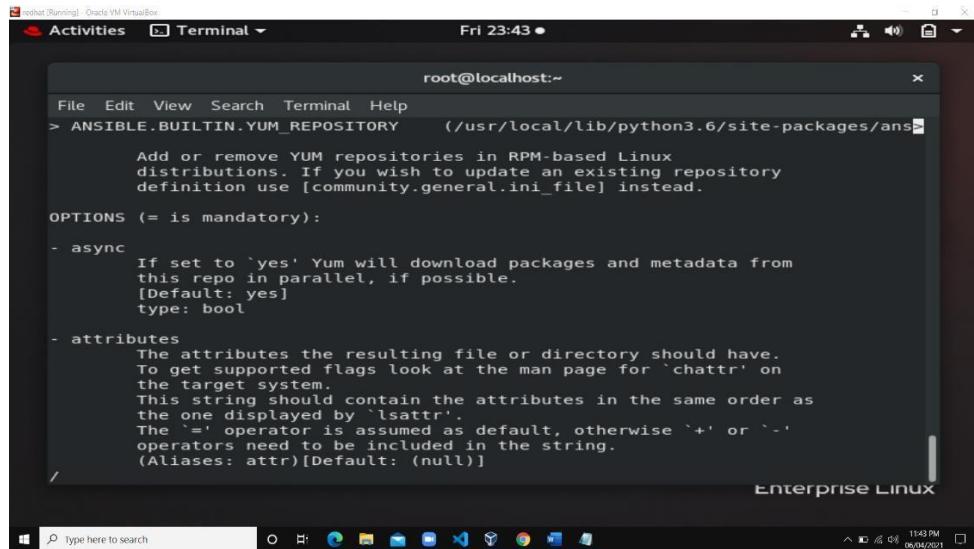
- **Search of specific keyword in the output of ansible-doc**

Once the output of “`ansible-doc module_name`” command is displayed then you can search for any specific keywords or also you can directly jump to EXAMPLES.

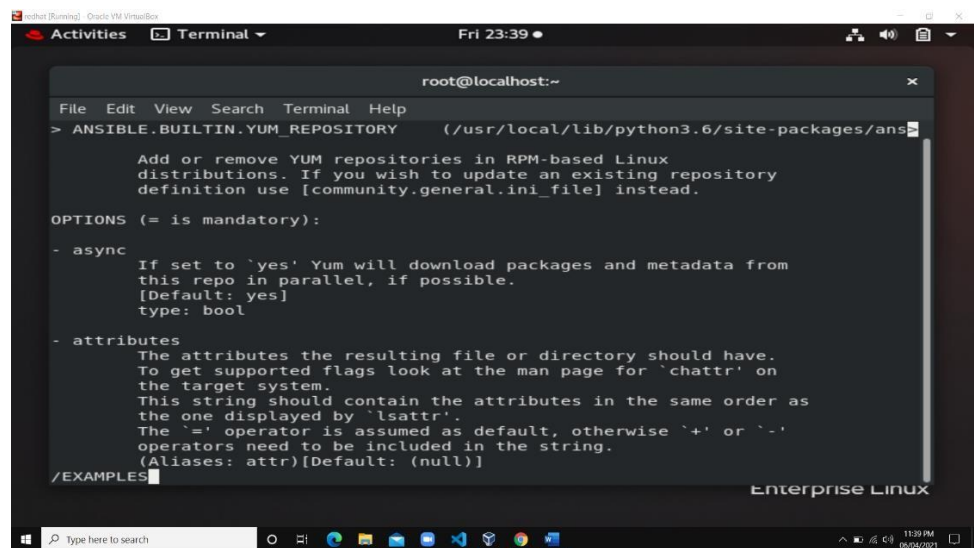
1. Press /
2. Enter the pattern to search after /
3. Press Enter to perform the search
4. Press n to find the next occurrence or N to find the previous occurrence.

Note: You can use similar approach in vim editor also.

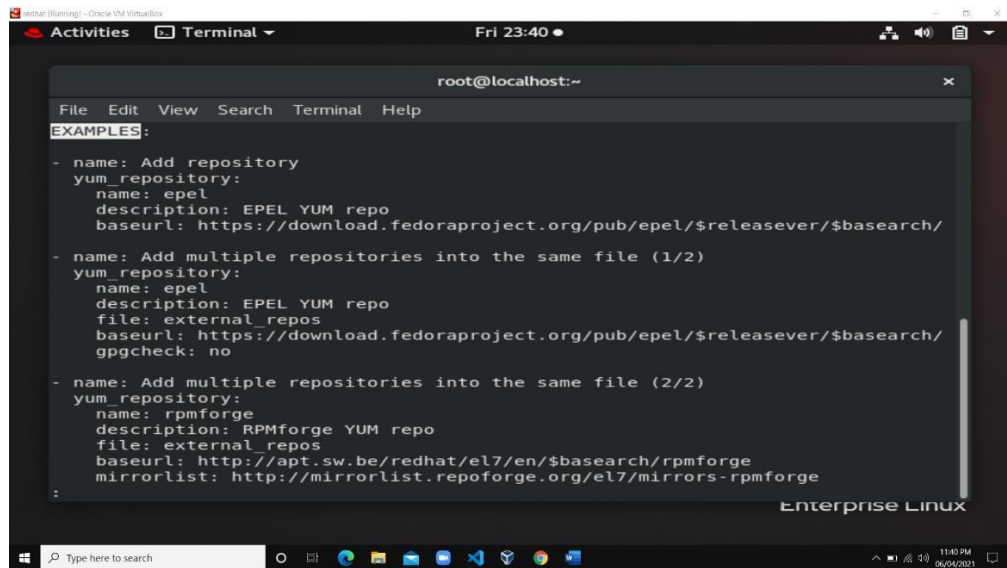
Examples Screenshot is attached in next page.



```
root@localhost:~  
File Edit View Search Terminal Help  
> ANSIBLE.BUILTIN.YUM_REPOSITORY (/usr/local/lib/python3.6/site-packages/ans  
Add or remove YUM repositories in RPM-based Linux  
distributions. If you wish to update an existing repository  
definition use [community.general.ini_file] instead.  
  
OPTIONS (= is mandatory):  
  
- async  
  If set to 'yes' Yum will download packages and metadata from  
  this repo in parallel, if possible.  
  [Default: yes]  
  type: bool  
  
- attributes  
  The attributes the resulting file or directory should have.  
  To get supported flags look at the man page for 'chattr' on  
  the target system.  
  This string should contain the attributes in the same order as  
  the one displayed by 'lsattr'.  
  The '=' operator is assumed as default, otherwise '+' or '-'  
  operators need to be included in the string.  
  (Aliases: attr)[Default: (null)]  
/  
Enterprise Linux
```



```
root@localhost:~  
File Edit View Search Terminal Help  
> ANSIBLE.BUILTIN.YUM_REPOSITORY (/usr/local/lib/python3.6/site-packages/ans  
Add or remove YUM repositories in RPM-based Linux  
distributions. If you wish to update an existing repository  
definition use [community.general.ini_file] instead.  
  
OPTIONS (= is mandatory):  
  
- async  
  If set to 'yes' Yum will download packages and metadata from  
  this repo in parallel, if possible.  
  [Default: yes]  
  type: bool  
  
- attributes  
  The attributes the resulting file or directory should have.  
  To get supported flags look at the man page for 'chattr' on  
  the target system.  
  This string should contain the attributes in the same order as  
  the one displayed by 'lsattr'.  
  The '=' operator is assumed as default, otherwise '+' or '-'  
  operators need to be included in the string.  
  (Aliases: attr)[Default: (null)]  
/EXAMPLES  
Enterprise Linux
```



The screenshot shows a terminal window titled 'root@localhost:~' with a menu bar (File, Edit, View, Search, Terminal, Help). The terminal displays three examples of Ansible playbooks for adding repositories. The first example adds a single repository named 'epel'. The second example adds multiple repositories to a file, including 'epel'. The third example adds multiple repositories to a file, including 'rpmforge'. The terminal also shows the 'Enterprise Linux' logo in the bottom right corner.

```
root@localhost:~  
File Edit View Search Terminal Help  
EXAMPLES:  
- name: Add repository  
  yum_repository:  
    name: epel  
    description: EPEL YUM repo  
    baseurl: https://download.fedoraproject.org/pub/epel/$releasever/$basearch/  
- name: Add multiple repositories into the same file (1/2)  
  yum_repository:  
    name: epel  
    description: EPEL YUM repo  
    file: external_repos  
    baseurl: https://download.fedoraproject.org/pub/epel/$releasever/$basearch/  
    gpgcheck: no  
- name: Add multiple repositories into the same file (2/2)  
  yum_repository:  
    name: rpmforge  
    description: RPMforge YUM repo  
    file: external_repos  
    baseurl: http://apt.sw.be/redhat/el7/en/$basearch/rpmforge  
    mirrorlist: http://mirrorlist.repoforge.org/el7/mirrors-rpmforge  
:
```

- You can use two terminals in exam. One for creating playbooks and another for testing or checking ansible-doc.
- You can also create backup of main folder in /temp folder as taught by sir.